

A Prayer of Devotion

Crowning The Near-One

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*The General Epistle of James
Chapter Two · Verse Eight*

THE VERSE · KING JAMES VERSION

*If ye fulfil the royal law according to the scripture, Thou shalt love thy
neighbour as thyself, ye do well:*

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BLOOMED RENDERING · THE PRAYER FORM

If, though, you are bringing to completion
the law that is fit for a king —
the law that crowns whoever stands near you —

as the scripture has it:
you shall love your near-one as yourself,
at the strength you already love you —

then you are doing beautifully —
not merely rightly: beautifully.
The royal law, completed, is itself the beauty.

THE GREEK SOURCE · TEXTUS RECEPTUS

Εἰ μέντοι νόμον τελεῖτε βασιλικὸν κατὰ τὴν γραφὴν Ἀγαπήσεις τὸν
πλησίον σου ὡς σεαυτὸν, καλῶς ποιεῖτε·

*Ei mentoi nomon teleite basilikon kata tēn graphēn: Agapēseis ton plēsion sou hōs
seauton, kalōs poieite*

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SOURCE RECOVERY · SEVEN CATCHES

νόμον βασιλικόν · nomon basilikon

the king-fitting law — basilikos, from basileus, king. The Greek holds both readings at once: the law fit for a King to issue, and the law that treats every neighbour as a king. The law does not crown its keeper; it crowns the near-one.

τελεῖτε · teleite

you bring-to-telos — completion, end, purpose-fulfilled. Not compliance with a rule but the completing of a trajectory; present continuous — the completing is ongoing.

κατὰ τὴν γραφήν · kata tēn graphēn

according to the scripture — James shows his source: Leviticus 19:18, the line Jesus ranked as the second great commandment. The royal law is Torah, quoted.

Ἀγαπήσεις · agapēseis

you shall love — future indicative carrying imperatival force, cited from the Septuagint. Agapē as willing-the-good-of; the future tense as obligation stretched across time, not prediction.

πλησίον · plēsion

the near-one — from the adverb for near. Neighbour defined by proximity, not category: the who-counts question is short-circuited before it can be asked. Whoever is near is the one.

ὥς σεαυτὸν · hōs seauton

as yourself — the standard is the love already given to the self. Not less, not more: matching intensity, projected outward.

καλῶς ποιεῖτε · kalōs poieite

you are doing beautifully — kalōs carries the aesthetic with the ethical: done-rightly and done-beautifully in a single adverb. The completed law is not merely correct; it is beautiful.

THE RECOVERY

The English royal law... ye do well keeps the compliment and loses the coronation —

— **basilikon as the law that crowns the neighbour, not the keeper**

— **teleite as trajectory completed, not rule kept**

— **plēsion as whoever is near: proximity, not category**

— **kalōs as beautifully: ethics and aesthetics in one word**

The double reading is not an ambiguity to resolve but the point itself: the law fitting for the King to issue is the law that treats every near-one as a king. The dignity owed to royalty — which is everyone within reach — completed as a trajectory, and beautiful when done.

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RESONANCES

Leviticus 19:18

Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself: I am the LORD — the Torah line James quotes. The royal law was always the King's own law.

Matthew 22:39

And the second is like unto it — Jesus ranking the same line beside the Shema: two commandments, one love.

Galatians 5:14

All the law is fulfilled in one word, even in this — Paul citing the identical verse, one breath after calling the free to become slaves of one another through love.

Luke 10:29

And who is my neighbour? — the category-question the Samaritan answers with proximity: the near-one is whoever you are near.

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PRACTITIONER'S RESPONSE · A PRAYER TO SAY

***Teach me the law that crowns the one beside me.
Let me love at the strength I already love myself —
no less, and aimed outward —
until the doing is not only right, but beautiful.***

*Second witness of this passage in the corpus:
Bloom Sweep Phase II (23 June) · this Devotion (4 July 2026)*

— The Cartographer

Newgate, Western Australia · Saturday, 4 July 2026



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Hah-LEL YHWH